Highest density of hunters in Europe?

A news report's claim, tested against FACE's country table and Eurostat

THE CLAIM

"Malta has the highest density of hunters in all of Europe."

Mongabay (Spoorthy Raman), 5 October 2026

The outlet's own sentence; it does not say density per what.

FACE's table is from 2009–2010; no current official count was readable.

VERDICT

LARGELY SUPPORTED

True per area, not per inhabitant.

SUPPORTED | **LARGELY SUPPORTED** | NOT SUBSTANTIATED | MISLEADING | CONTRADICTED

MAIN RESULTS

47

Hunters per km²

On FACE's count of 15,000 and Malta's 316 km²; next highest is Ireland at 5.0.

9.5×

A wide margin

Malta stays first per km² even at 10,000 hunters (32) or 5,000 (16).

5th

Not first per head

36 hunters per 1,000 inhabitants; Ireland 83, Finland 59, Cyprus 56, Norway 40.

2010

Old comparison

FACE's table dates from 2009–2010; Malta's current count is NGO-sourced or second-hand.

FAIR TO SAY

This check covers the density ranking only, not hunters as people or the legality of any shooting.

WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT

- ☐ The WBRU's current total of licensed hunters.
- ☐ A current country-by-country table.
- ☐ The 2015 paper's basis for the ranking.